6]

Khariton and Zel’dovich develop the theory of a chain reaction of nuclear fissions. [Ch. 6]

The German army invades Poland, setting off World War 11.

1942 The U.S. launches a crash program to develop the atomic bomb, led by Oppenheimer. [Ch. 6]

1943 The U.S.S.R. launches a low-level effort to design nuclear reactors and atomic bombs, with Zel’dovich as a lead theorist. [Ch. 6]

1945 The U.S. drops atomic bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki. World War 11 ends. A low-level U.S. effort to develop the superbomb is begun. [Ch. 6]

The U.S.S.R. launches a crash program to develop the atomic bomb, with Zel’dovich as a lead theorist. [Ch. 6]

1946 Friedman and his team launch the first astronomical instrument above the Earth’s atmosphere, on a captured German V-2 rocket. [Ch. 8]

Experimental physicists in England and Australia begin constructing radio telescopes and radio interferometers. [Ch. 9]

1948 Zel’dovich” Sakharov, Ginzburg, and others in the U.S.S.R. initiate design work for a superbomb (hydrogen bomb); Ginzburg invents the LiD fuel, Sakharov the layered-cake design. [Ch. 6]

1949 The U.S.S.R. explodes its first atomic bomb, setting off a debate in the U.S. about a crash program to develop the superbomb. The D.S.S.R. proceeds directly into a crash program for the superbomb, without debate. [Ch. 6]

1950 The V.S. launches a crash superbomb effort. [Ch. 6]

Kiepenheuer and Ginzburg realize that cosmic radio waves are produced by cosmic-ray electrons spiraling in interstellar